

No IE for Mac

Microsoft has halted the development of Internet Explorer for the Apple platform. Although security and performance updates may be provided, no new versions will be released. The company feels that Apple's browser, Safari, is better suited for Apple customers. Microsoft also said that it does not have access to Macintosh, which it needs to compete against Safari. The 5-year deal that the company had with Apple for providing Mac versions of its browser and Office suite, has expired. This may put the Mac community in a fix, as many sites need Internet Explorer for optimum viewing. Surveys show its market to be an astounding 95 percentage.

Apple launched the development of its browser in January this year, based on the open-source KHTML development project, which is designed for use with KDE.

Although Apple has released many versions of the Safari, a final version is yet to be released.

snapshot

There are close to 13,000 Wi-Fi access points in Manhattan, New York; 9,669 are open non-WEP nodes and 4,038 closed WEP nodes

Source: Intel and the Public Internet Project

Super fast Internet2

In a recent development, a research team at California Institute of Technology have developed a system called Fast TCP, which could run on the same Internet infrastructure we have today.

In Fast TCP, the time taken by the packets to reach, and the time taken by acknowledgements to come back is measured continuously. This reveals the delays on the line, giving early warnings of likely packet losses. The Fast TCP software uses this to predict the highest data rate the connection can sup-

port without losing data.

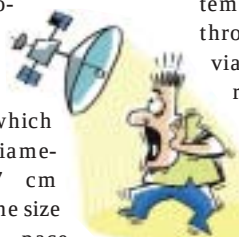
By ganging 10 Fast TCP systems together, the researchers achieved transmission speeds of over 8.6 Gbps, which is more than 6000 times the capacity of ordinary broadband links.

In a collateral effort, researchers at Los Alamos National Labs were able to send one terabyte of data from California to Geneva in under an hour using 10 Gig E NICs from Intel, with a standard Linux TCP implementation. At this 2.38 GBps rate, users could send a full CD in 2.3 seconds, or 200 full-length DVD movies in an hour.



The mother of all big brothers

Applied Digital Solutions (ADS) has taken a step into the future, with the testing of its prototype sub-dermal GPS tracking device—Digital Angel, which is 6.35 cm in diameter and 1.27 cm thick—about the size of a cardiac pacemaker. It is designed to fit into the human chest cavity, so as to be able to track you wherever you go.



The device consists of an antenna and an induction-based rechargeable battery system that can be recharged through your skin. It connects via a cell phone network to relay the satellite tracking data to another person.

There are also chips under development that could monitor your child and tell you when he falls, or how bad the wound is, or tell the paramedics about his existing allergies, and finally give the doctors at the hospital the entire medical history. You could even be automatically billed for the medical expenses, with the identification and health insurance chip that could be embedded in your hand. Although this may sound too farfetched, the only factor standing in the way of their implementation is public acceptance.



heroes

3G

3G just got a shot in the arm after NTT DoCoMo exhibited its products and services at CeBIT, New York. DoCoMo is now planning to introduce fuel cell powered 3G phones by 2004.

Open Source

To combat proprietary licenses, Brazil plans to migrate 80 per cent of all computers in state institutions and state owned companies from Windows to open source solutions, such as Linux. In Europe, Munich too has opted to put in Linux in over 14,000 desktop PCs.

E-Commerce

E-commerce is picking up in Europe. A recent study predicts that European e-commerce should cross the \$200 billion mark by 2006.

zeroes

Online file sharing

A bill currently being debated in the US Congress, will permit the FBI to develop a program to track online file-swapping for copyright violations. The information gleaned could be shared between other law enforcement agencies, as well as copyright owners and ISPs.

DVD

With the threat of DRM implementation in DVDs and CDs, the format is attracting the ire of consumers. Other than Sony and Iomega, no other company made DVD writers that are compatible with all exiting formats.

Wi-Fi

In Europe, Wi-Fi hasn't taken off as expected. Analysts say that the service is bound to be patchy, and roaming with Wi-Fi equipment will be cumbersome due to incompatible billing systems.

■ Transmeta signs a deal to develop, and sell its Linux versions meant for embedded devices in China, and the Asia Pacific